

ENGLISH MAJORSHIP QUESTIONS AND RATIONALE

1. Who said ask not what your country can do for you, but what you can do for your country?

A. Richard M. Nixon

B. Lyndon B. Johnson

C. Dwight D. Eisenhower

D. John F. Kennedy

RATIONALE: (D. John F. Kennedy)

On January 20, 1961, President John F. Kennedy delivered his inaugural address at the height of the Cold War. One of the most striking lines in his speech is “ask not what your country can do for you, but what you can do for your country” which paved the way for people to realize what it means to be an American: that more than anything, it is their duty to be of service to others.

**2. She is GENEROUS TO A
FAULT.**

A. Seldom

B. Rarely

C. Infrequently

D. Excessively

RATIONALE: (D. Excessively)

"Generous to a fault" is an idiomatic expression which means "too generous; overly generous." When a person exhibits such generosity, it means that he or she manifests it in ways "more" than the usual. The closest answer is (D) "excessively" - a word which indicates that something "goes beyond what is usual, normal, or proper. (A) Seldom, (B) rarely, and (C) infrequently all mean the same thing: not happening often."

3. Charlie's grandmother is already ninety five years old. She is AS BLIND AS A BAT.

A. Having one blind eye

B. Having total blindness

C. Having a very poor vision

D. Having a slightly poor vision

RATIONALE: (C. Having a very poor vision)

“Blind as a bat” is an idiomatic expression which means “not able to see well” or “poor vision.” Before, people think that bats are totally blind but the truth is, they only have poor eyesight. Given this, letters A and B should be omitted since the aforementioned phrase does not suggest “blindness.” While D (Slightly poor vision) is the second best option considering that the grandmother is already 95 years old.

**4. Richard REVOLVED to
act more wisely next time.**

A. Hoped

B. Consented

C. Promised

D. Decided

RATIONALE: (C. Promised)

The phrase “act MORE wisely next time” suggests that some “revolving” or change SHOULD happen or be done and not just thought of. Letter C (Promise/d) means “to show signs of something that is expected to happen.” Letter D (Decide/d) is only the second best option because decisions are based on options as well as pieces of evidence and the former and the latter are not emphasized in the sentence. Letter A (Hope/d) and Letter B (Consented) are less likely the answers because Richard cannot just “want” or “agree” to be more wise in the future.

5. PUNCTUALITY is imposed in this office.

A. Being efficient

B. Being Cheerful

C. Being courteous

D. Being on time

RATIONALE: (C. Being on time)

When someone is punctual, he or she arrives/does something at the expected or planned time. Letter B (Cheerful) and C (Courteous) are not strong grounds to be imposed in an office. While D has something to do with the capacity to produce desired results.

6. The marketing officers were asked to GO OVER the figures in their reports before the conference.

A. Calculate

B. Revise

C. Review

D. Compute

RATIONALE: (C. Review)

“Go over” is an example of a phrasal verb which means “examine, consider, or check the details.” The closest answer would be (C) Review – to look at or examine.

7. The woman reported that the diamonds snatched from her were GENUINE.

A. Real

B. Valuable

C. Synthetic

D. Imitations

RATIONALE: (A. Real)

“Genuine” means “actual, real, or true.” (C) Synthetic and (D) Imitations are antonyms of the former. While (B) Valuable is less of a reason for the diamonds to be REPORTED missing than (A) Real.

**8. Two friends had a serious fight and another friend came to
POUR OIL ON TROUBLED WATERS.**

A. To worsen the guilt

B. To worsen the fight

C. To smooth out a quarrel

D. To put the blame on them

RATIONALE: (C. To smooth out a quarrel)

"Pour oil on troubled waters" is an idiomatic expression which means "to try to stop a quarrel." (A) To worsen the guilt, (B) To worsen the fight, and (D) To put the blame on them - the following answers signify a worsening of the situation per se. And to think, a friend in his right mind who sees his friends fighting would not make things worse nor put the blame on them but help them patch things up.

**9. Nobody wants to listen to him.
He always BATS THE BREEZE.**

A. Talk Cruelly

B. Talk rudely

C. Talk nonsense or exaggerate

D. Talk indiscreetly

RATIONALE: (C. Talk nonsense)

When one “bats the breeze,” he or she chats aimlessly or casually, without any serious topic. (C) is the best answer because if the conversation is serious it would have some “sense.” (A) Talk Cruelly, (B) Talk rudely, (D) Talk indiscreetly would require a negative reaction as well – not merely indifference (nobody WANTS to listen) but perhaps annoyance or anger.

10. He dreams of becoming a lawyer. However, his dream is somewhat a BIRD IN THE BUSH.

A. Illusion

B. Uncertain

C. Allusion

D. Extraordinary

RATIONALE: (B. Uncertain)

The phrase “bird in the bush” came from the expression: A bird in the hand is worth two in the bush. This means that it is better to have an advantage or opportunity that is certain than having one that is worth more but is not so certain. “A bird in the hand” is yours, and it’s not going anywhere unless you let it go. But if you leave it and go for “two in the bush,” there is no guarantee you’ll catch them, you might end up with nothing in the end. In connection to the given sentence, if there’s no guarantee, then there’s (B) uncertainty when it comes to HIS dreams.

**11. Wincey is quite happy
now that she LIVES IN
CLOVER.**

A. Happiness

B. Lives with her family

**C. Lives close to her relatives &
friends**

RATIONALE: (A. Happiness)

If you are “in clover,” you are “happy or secure because you have a lot of money or are enjoying a luxurious lifestyle.” Since there is no money involved, the best answer which is nearest to the definition is (A) happiness.

**12. Cleanliness is still at a
DISCOUNT in many parts of
the of the country.**

A. Believed

B. Attended to

C. Not to be valued fully

D. Valued full

RATIONALE: (C. Not to be valued fully)

One meaning of the word discount is “price” reduction. With this, one can replace price with cleanliness. If cleanliness is “reduced,” then, it must not be valued to its fullest. While A, B, and D, are all positive words.

13. Carry on with your work.

A. Be on time

B. Continue

C. Carry to work

D. Stop

RATIONALE: (C. Continue)

"Carry on" is an example of a phrasal verb which means "continue an activity or task." The closest answer would be (D) Continue.

**14. Lolo Carrito is really
_____ man.**

A. A sweet, old.

B. A sweet old

C. A sweet oldy

D. An old sweet

RATIONALE: (A. A sweet, old)

COORDINATE VERSUS CUMULATIVE ADJECTIVES

The comma rule comes down to the difference between the two kinds of adjectives: coordinate and cumulative. Coordinate adjectives are adjectives in a row that **EACH SEPARATELY** modify the noun that follows as in “heavy, bulky box.” Both heavy and bulky modify the “box.” You can even rearrange the adjectives and say “bulky, heavy box.”

Cumulative adjectives, on the other hand, don’t separately modify the noun that follows even though they are all stacked up before the noun. Instead, the adjective right before the noun pairs with the noun as a unit, and the adjective before that unit modifies that. An example would be, “exquisite custom houseboat,” “custom” modifies “houseboat” – they become one unit – and then “exquisite” modifies “custom houseboat.” Unlike coordinate adjectives, you can’t rearrange cumulative adjectives because it would sound awkward.

RATIONALE: (A. A sweet, old)

COORDINATE VERSUS CUMULATIVE ADJECTIVES

CONTINUATION:

> Use Commas When You Could Add an “AND”

If you can separate the words with “and,” then you can separate them with commas. Also if you can rearrange adjectives, then you can separate them with commas.

In the given sentence, both sweet and old modify the “man.” You can even rearrange the adjectives and say “sweet, old man.” As such, sweet and old are coordinate adjectives, thus, a comma is appropriate.

The Order of Adjectives

1. Determiner (Article, Number) – A ; 2. Opinion – sweet ; 3. Size ; 4. Shape ; 5. Age – old ; 6. Color ; 7. Nationality/Origin ; 8. Material ; 9. Purpose

**15. The Mustang used to be
_____ sports car.**

A. Fine German

B. A fine German

C. A German, fine

D. A fine, German

RATIONALE: (B. A fine German)

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RATIONALE: (B. A fine German)

COORDINATE VERSUS CUMULATIVE ADJECTIVES

CONTINUATION:

> Use Commas When You Could Add an “AND”

If you can separate the words with “and,” then you can separate them with commas. Also if you can rearrange adjectives, then you can separate them with commas.

In the given sentence, although it seems like you can add the word “and” between “fine” and “German,” it would still sound awkward if you rearrange the adjectives and say “German, fine car.” With this arrangement, it implies that the given adjectives are cumulative because it makes more sense that “fine” modifies “German car” (that it’s a fine German – not American car). As such, “fine” and “German” are more likely cumulative adjectives, thus, no commas are needed.

16. Everyone was home for the holidays. What could make for _____ Christmas than that?

A. A Merriest

B. A merry

C. The Merriest

D. A merrier

RATIONALE: (D. A Merrier)

RULES ON THE INDEFINITE AND DEFINITE ARTICLE WITH ADJECTIVES

- DO NOT use the definite article with the comparative.

Example:

Correct – Today is a colder day THAN yesterday.

Incorrect – Today is **the** colder day THAN yesterday.

- Use the definitive article with the SUPERLATIVE.

Examples:

This **THE** best steak I have ever eaten.

This is **THE** largest country in the world.

The sentence suggests a comparison with the use of than and the comparative form of merry is merrier, hence, the answer is D.

**17. Those are probably the
_____ blankets in the store.**

A. Most fancy

B. Fanciest

C. Least Fancy

D. Most Fanciest

RATIONALE: (B. Fanciest)

RULES ON FORMING SUPERLATIVE ADJECTIVES

SUPERLATIVE

Method: Add est

> One syllable

> Two syllables that end in Y

Ex. The puppy is the naughtiest of all animals.

The sentence calls for a superlative adjective. All other choices appear “superlative” in a sense but the right way to make fancy superlative is “fanciest” - based on the rule above. Hence, the answer is B.

18. Marylou and Miranda grew up in _____ house in Cabanatuan City.

- A. A little, comfortable**
- B. A comfortable, little**
- C. Comfortable a little**
- D. A comfortable little**

RATIONALE: (B. A comfortable, little)

COORDINATE VERSUS CUMULATIVE ADJECTIVES

The comma rule comes down to the difference between the two kinds of adjectives: coordinate and cumulative. Coordinate adjectives are adjectives in a row that EACH SEPARATELY modify the noun that follows as in “heavy, bulky box.” Both heavy and bulky modify the “box.” You can even rearrange the adjectives and say “bulky, heavy box.”

Cumulative adjectives, on the other hand, don’t separately modify the noun that follows even though they are all stacked up before the noun. Instead, the adjective right before the noun pairs with the noun as a unit, and the adjective before that unit modifies that. An example would be, “exquisite custom houseboat,” “custom” modifies “houseboat” – they become one unit – and then “exquisite” modifies “custom houseboat.” Unlike coordinate adjectives, you can’t rearrange cumulative adjectives because it would sound awkward.

RATIONALE: (A. A comfortable, little)

COORDINATE VERSUS CUMULATIVE ADJECTIVES

CONTINUATION:

> Use Commas When You Could Add an “AND”

If you can separate the words with “and,” then you can separate them with commas. Also if you can rearrange adjectives, then you can separate them with commas.

In the given sentence, both comfortable and little modify the “house.” You can even rearrange the adjectives and say “little, comfortable house.” As such, little and comfortable are coordinate adjectives, thus, a comma is appropriate.

The Order of Adjectives

1. Determiner (Article, Number) – A ; 2. Opinion – comfortable ; 3. Size - little ; 4. Shape ; 5. Age ; 6. Color ; 7. Nationality/Origin ; 8. Material ; 9. Purpose

**19. Space age _____ on
Dec. 21, 1957 when sputnik was
launched by the Soviet Union.**

A. Cited

B. Ended

C. Flourished

D. Commenced

RATIONALE: (D. Commenced)

(A) Cited – to write or say the words (of a book, author)

(B) Ended – the point at which something no longer continues to happen or exist

(C) Flourished – to be in a state of activity or production

(D) Commenced – to begin

Because of Sputnik, the beginning of Space Age happened on December 21, 1957. Hence, the best answer is (D).

20. Students _____ near the registrar's office to ask for their schedule.

A. Disperse

B. Crowd

C. Congregate

D. Stay idling

RATIONALE: (B. Crowd)

(A) Disperse – to spread apart

**(B) Crowd – to press, force, or thrust into a small place;
to collect in numbers**

**(C) Congregate – to come together into a group or
crowd**

(D) Stay idling – to not have much activity

The less likely answers are (A) and (D) while the two best options are (B) and (C). The latter and the former have almost the same meaning but (C) Congregate - is used with established groups (rather than just with random students) and is more planned/formal. Hence, the best answer is (B) crowd.

21. “A man is known by the company he keeps.” This is an example of a:

A. Rule

B. Report

C. Proverb

D. Poem

RATIONALE: (C. Proverb)

Proverb – is a brief, simple, and popular saying or phrase that gives pieces of advice and effectively embodies a commonplace truth based on experience or common sense.

Rule – are instructions that tell you what you are allowed to do and what you are not allowed to do.

Report – story in a newspaper or on radio or television that gives information about something.

Poem – a piece of writing that usually has figurative language and that is written in separate lines that often have a repeated rhythm and sometimes rhyme.

In the given sentence, the example is BRIEF (unlike poems and reports) unstrict (unlike rules) and is TRUE based on experience. Hence, the answer is C.

22. News travels as far as the wind. This statement is an/a:

A. Metaphor

B. Simile

C. Synonym

D. Idiom

RATIONALE: (B. Simile)

Simile "a figure of speech comparing two unlike things that is often introduced by like or as." In the given sentence, the way that a news travels is likened to the way the air travels - that is, "far." Moreover, it uses "as." Metaphor is like simile; however, the former does not use "like" or "as." (C) Synonym is the "meaning" of a certain word or phrase. While (D) Idiom is an expression that cannot be understood from the meanings of its separate words but that has a separate meaning of its own.

23. She has a PENCHANT for red accessories. This indicates:

A. Dislike

B. Fondness

C. Avoidance

D. Strong aversion

RATIONALE: (B. Fondness)

Penchant – a strong liking for something

The word liking is synonymous with the word fondness which is a positive word. While A, B, and D are all negative words.

24. He is an _____ member of the community.

- A. Imminent**
- B. Immanent**
- C. Eminent**
- D. Imminent**

RATIONALE: (C. Eminent)

Letters (A) and (D) Imminent (are just the same) – and means happening very soon

(B) Immanent – means inherent/inborn

(C) Eminent – successful, well-known, and respected

In the sentence, the appropriate adjective to describe the subject he – as a member of the community is eminent or successful.

25.

A. The criteria for judging the candidates have been finalized.

B. The criteria for judging the candidate has been finalized.

C. The criteria has been finalized for judging the candidate.

D. The criteria was finalized for judging the candidate.

RATIONALE: (A)

In this case, one should identify even the smallest error possible to know the correct answer.

The word criteria is a PLURAL noun, thus, requiring a plural verb. Letters B, C, and D have singular verbs - “has been,” “has been,” “was finalized” - which make each of them disagree with the plural noun criteria. Hence, the answer is A.

26.

A. One of the examinees have not been in the registry unit.

B. One of the examinees were not in the registry list.

C. One of the examinees were not registered.

D. One of the examinees was not registered.

RATIONALE: (D)

This is a case of an incorrect subject verb agreement.

(D) One of the examinees was not registered.

In the correct sentence, “one” is a singular subject and “was” is a singular verb, making them agree with each other.

While in letters (A) (B) and (C), the verbs are plural, making them disagree with the subject “one.”

27.

A. While taking a shower, someone rang the doorbell.

B. While I was taking a shower, the doorbell rang.

C. While I was showering, the doorbell ring.

D. While taking a shower, the doorbell ring.

RATIONALE: (B)

Letters (A) and (D) lack a doer of the action, making both sentences vague.

Letter (C), on the other hand, does not conform to the rule of parallelism. The verb was is in its past tense and is not parallel with the verb ring which is in its present tense.

Hence, the one that is not vague and follows the rule of parallelism is B.

28.

A. Many glasses are invisible, odorless and tasteless.

B. Many glasses are invisible, odorless and have no taste.

C. Many glasses are invisible, odorless and they have no taste.

D. Many glasses are invisible and they have no odors and taste.

RATIONALE: (A)

(A) Many glasses are invisible, odorless and tasteless.

All other choices violate the rule of parallelism. The sentence require a one word adjective but letters (B), (C), and (D) add the word “have” to it.

29.

A. It is a privilege to be a member of the prestigos organization.

B. It is a privilege to be a member of the prestigius organization.

C. It is a privilege to be a member of the prestigious organization.

D. It is a priviledge to be a member of the prestigious organization.

RATIONALE: (C)

Letters (A), (B), and (D) have an error in terms of spelling.

(A) and (B) – wrong spelling of “prestigious.”

(D) – wrong spelling of “privilege.”

**30. We should work for the
total ban _____ of
pesticides.**

A. By the use

B. With

C. On using

D. On the use

RATIONALE: (D. On the use)

“On” is the correct preposition to supply the sentence.

Between “on using,” and “on the use,” the latter is correct because of the preposition “of” which signals that the word “use” is used as a noun and not as a verb.

31. The Rizal day celebration reminds us about heroes' worth:

- A. Emulating**
- B. Appreciating**
- C. Studying**
- D. Reading About**

RATIONALE: (A. Emulating)

Apart from reading about heroes and studying about heroes on Rizal day, the far more meaningful/worthy thing to do is to emulate or “be like” such heroes.

Appreciating is less likely the answer because there's a fine line that separates appreciating and admiring: appreciating is for things while admiring is for people, that is when it comes to grammar and correct usage.

**32. Mathematics _____ the
most difficult subject in the
board exam.**

A. Remains

B. Remain

C. Has remains

D. Remaining

RATIONALE: (A. Remains)

The word “Mathematics” may be plural in form but it is singular in meaning, making it require a singular verb.

(B) Remain – is a plural verb

(C) Has remains – looks like a singular verb because of has but the word remains makes it wrong; pattern should be has + base form (and remains is not the base form)

D – Remaining – lacks a linking verb to match the singular noun “Mathematics.”

**33. Many a man _____ to
be rich and famous.**

A. Desires

B. Desiring

C. Is Desiring

D. Desire

RATIONALE: (A. Desires)

“Many a” – according to the subject-verb agreement rules - is always singular. Hence, the phrase needs a singular verb as well.

(B) Desiring – lacks a linking verb to match the singular subject “Many a.”

(C) Is Desiring – singular verb (but between “desires” and “is desiring,” the one that is shorter is more appropriate and chosen.

(D) Desire – plural verb

34. Neither his father nor his sisters _____ mahjong.

A. Plays

B. Are play

C. Are plays

D. Play

RATIONALE: (D. Play)

Rule on Subject-Verb Agreement:

> Compound subjects joined by or/nor, the verb agrees with the subject nearer to it.

The subject nearest to the verb is SISTERS. And sisters is plural. Likewise, (D) Play is a plural verb, making both agree with each other.

(A) Plays - singular

(B) Are play – may be plural but wrong pattern

(C) Are plays – may be plural but wrong pattern

Are + play + ing = are playing

**35. Tess and I met a friend of
_____ at Robinson's yesterday.**

A. Them

B. Us

C. We

D. Their

RATIONALE: (B. Us)

SUBJECT PRONOUNS (subjects of a verb/sentence) Ex. HE is my friend.	OBJECT PRONOUNS (functions as the object of a verb/preposition) Ex. He begged HER to live with HIM.	POSSESSIVE ADJECTIVE/PRONOUNS (shows possession) Ex. The cat is HIS.
I	Me	My/Mine
He	Him	His/His
She	Her	Her/Hers
It	It	Its/Its
You (Singular) You (Plural)	You You	Your/Yours Your/Yours
They	Them	Their/Theirs
We	Us	Our/Ours

RATIONALE: (B. Us)

The correct answer should be really OURS which is a possessive pronoun.

(A) Them – Object pronoun (not parallel “Tess and I.”)

(C) We – subject pronoun (parallel with “Tess and I” but is a subject pronoun)

(D) Their – possessive pronoun (but not parallel with “Tess and I.”)

We are left with two “best” choices: (C) which is a subject pronoun or (B) which is an object pronoun. Both are parallel with “Tess and I” but the latter is better because it is closer to the order of pronouns. And it sounds better as well.

**36. The _____ wiring is the
cause of the sudden
blackout.**

A. Loose

B. Lost

C. Lose

D. Losing

RATIONALE: (A. Loose)

(A) Loose – not tightly fastened, attached, or held

According to studies, if a wire is “loose,” it can cause abnormal arcing around its point of connection, usually resulting in the neutral wire becoming unusually hot, burning its insulation off and even causing damage to its surroundings.

(B) Lost – unable to be found (if you can't find the wiring, then, more likely it won't cause trouble)

(C) Lose – to be unable to find (can't use this because it is a verb)

(D) Losing – resulting in defeat (inappropriate adjective because the wiring is not in defeat)

37. You know we can't pay such high monthly rent. This condominium is too expensive for _____.

A. Them

B. Us

C. We

D. Their

RATIONALE: (B. Us)

SUBJECT PRONOUNS (subjects of a verb/sentence) Ex. HE is my friend.	OBJECT PRONOUNS (functions as the object of a verb/preposition) Ex. He begged HER to live with HIM.	POSSESSIVE ADJECTIVE/PRONOUNS (shows possession) Ex. The cat is HIS.
I	Me	My/Mine
He	Him	His/His
She	Her	Her/Hers
It	It	Its/Its
You (Singular) You (Plural)	You You	Your/Yours Your/Yours
They	Them	Their/Theirs
We	Us	Our/Ours

RATIONALE: (B. Us)

In the sentence, what is needed is an object pronoun. And the object pronoun parallel with “We” is “Us,” based on the given table.

38. You know we can't pay such high monthly rent. This condominium is too expensive for _____.

A. Herself

B. Her

C. Himself

D. Oneself

RATIONALE: (D. Oneself)

SUBJECT PRONOUNS (subjects of a verb/sentence) Ex. HE is my friend.	REFLEXIVE PRONOUNS (refer to the subject forms of personal pronouns) Ex. We didn't decorate it OURSELVES.
I	Myself
He	Himself
She	Herself
It	Itself
You (singular)	Yourself
You (plural)	Yourselves
They	Themselves
One	Oneself
We	Ourselves

RATIONALE: (D. Oneself)

- (A) Herself**
- (B) Her**
- (C) Himself**
- (D) Oneself**

All of the following choices are wrong. They are not parallel with “We.” And at the same time, we are looking for a reflexive pronoun. The real answer is OURSELVES. But just to choose something nearer to ourselves, we choose (D) Oneself.

39. The teacher gave _____ a literature from the Renaissance period.

A. Class

B. Classy

C. Classless

D. Classical

RATIONALE: (D. Classical)

(A) Class - a group of students; to decide that (someone or something) belongs to a particular group (can't use a noun and a verb to describe literature; inappropriate as well)

(B) Classy – having qualities that make someone or something special and attractive (less likely the answer)

(C) Classless – not connected to a particular social or economic class (more for “people” and not literature)

(D) Classical – of a kind that has been respected for a long time; of or relating to the ancient Greek and Roman world especially to its language, literature, art, etc.

Hence, the closest answer is (D).

40. In A Thousand and One Nights, Alibaba shouted, “Open Sesame!” to open a cave of riches. Since then the world took this to mean:

- A. A secret**
- B. Wealth**
- C. Power**
- D. A password**

RATIONALE: (D. A password)

“Open Sesame” means a “free or unrestricted means of admission or access.” If the cave opened after Alibaba shouted, then, it really must be a password because a password is “a secret word or phrase that must be used to gain admission to something.”

41. If she _____ President, she would live in Malacanang.

A. was

B. am

C. would be

D. were

RATIONALE: (D. were)

An unreal conditional sentence expresses events that are hypothetical or improbable. Typically, an unreal conditional sentence begins with an “if” clause containing the past tense or past perfect tense of a verb followed by a conditional clause containing a modal verb such as “would.”

Example:

If I had run the race, I would feel accomplished.

In both sentences above, the “if” clause contains a form of the past tense of the verb. There is one exception to this rule, however. If the verb if clause is “to be,” use “were” even if the subject of the clause is a third person singular subject. (i.e. he, she, it).

Incorrect: If I was a rich man, I would make more donations.

Correct: If I were a rich man, I would make more donations.

42. I should have returned the books to the library last Monday. They are now 3 days _____.

A. Deferred

B. Overdue

C. Delayed

D. Past the Deadline

RATIONALE: (B. Overdue)

(A) Deferred – withheld for or until a stated time (e.g. a deferred payment)

(B) Overdue – delayed beyond an appointed time (e.g. overdue train; overdue books)

(C) Delayed – a situation in which something happens later than it should (although it has a similar meaning with overdyed, the meaning doesn't emphasize "deadline")

(D) Past the Deadline – the deadline has passed (could also be an answer but the more concise – short and brief – answer should be chosen, hence, overdue).

43. What is the theme of the following quote? “Have a good bank account, a good cook and good digestion.”

- A. Security**
- B. Goodness**
- C. Preoccupation**
- D. Responsibility**

RATIONALE: (A. Security)

A. Security – to make something certain

B. Goodness – the quality or state of being good

C. Preoccupation – a state in which you give all your attention to something

D. Responsibility – a duty or task you are required or expected to do

If you have a good bank account, digestion, and cook, that means you are already secured, that is, you are certain that you won't have major problems in terms of your money, food, and partner in life.

44. Ralph Waldo Emerson once said, “A little knowledge is dangerous.”

A. Sport

B. Mind

C. Thing

D. Endeavor

RATIONALE: (B. Mind)

Among the choices, the most related word when knowledge is being talked about is (B) mind – as it is the generator of knowledge.

**45. In Benjamin Franklin's "Poor Richard's Almanac" it was said that:
"early to bed _____ makes a man
healthy..."**

- A. Early to rise**
- B. Early rising**
- C. Walking up early**
- D. Rising Early**

RATIONALE: (A. Early to rise)

The correct phrase to follow “early to bed” is “early to rise” based on Benjamin Franklin’s “Poor Richard’s Almanac.”

And if you are not really aware of this popular saying, one clue is the proper observation of “parallelism.” Since bed is preceded by the words “early to” then rise must also be (just to make sense of the grammar) preceded by the words, “early to.”

**46. I don't like sonorous sounds,
I prefer music that is PLEASING
to the ears.**

A. Calm

B. Soft

C. Loud

D. Quiet

RATIONALE: (B. Soft)

A. Calm – quiet and peaceful state or condition

B. Soft – pleasing or agreeable to the senses

C. Loud – making or causing a lot of noise

D. Quiet – the quality or state of being quiet or calm

The word pleasing is synonymous with the word soft, hence, the answer is (B).

47. She describes her classmate's statement as too SOPHOMORIC. This means:

- A. Mature**
- B. Immature**
- C. Grown-up**
- D. Wise**

RATIONALE: (B. Immature)

The word “sophomoric” is synonymous with the word “immature” which is a negative word. While A, C, and D are all positive words.

48. Which statement would someone refusing to take revenge likely utter?

A. “an eye for an eye”

B. “that is murder”

C. “justice delayed is justice denied

D. “do not take the law into your hand”

RATIONALE: (A. “an eye for an eye”)

“Only one eye for one eye” also known as “An eye for an eye” or “A tooth for a tooth” or the law of retaliation, is the principle that a person who has injured another person is to be penalized to a similar degree, and the person inflicting such punishment should be the injured party. It means that the victim receives the value of the injury in compensation. The intent behind the principle was to restrict compensation to the value of the loss.

(B) – just stating that it is murder

(C) - just stating that if the law is delayed, it is denied

(D) – explicitly expressing that one should not take the law into his own hands or revenge

49. A girl lost her pen. She said aloud, “Who _____?”

A. Stole from me

B. Dared touch my things

C. Made a mistake and picked my pen

D. Cannot be trusted among us

RATIONALE: (C.)

- (A) Stole from me
- (B) Dared touch my things
- (D) Cannot be trusted among us

The following options give off an accusatory tone. If these things shall be said by the owner, a negative reaction could materialize which could lead to arguments. Good communication involves diction, the proper choice of words. And it is only (C) Made a mistake and picked my pen - that maintains a calm tone for the said context.

50. Arrange the phrases below to make a correct sentence.

I. And the Department head

II. Are presenting the school

III. The Principal

IV. In the stake holder's meeting

A. IV, II, I and III

B. III, I, II and IV

C. III, IV, II and I

D. IV, III, I and II

RATIONALE: (D.)

A. IV, II, I and III (IV. In the stakeholder's meeting; II. Are presenting the school – WRONG – lacks sense, no doer of the action)

C. III, IV, II and I (III. The Principal; IV. In the stakeholder's meeting; II. Are presenting the school; I. And the Department head – WRONG – it is not only the head which should present the school but the principal as well)

Two best options are (B) and (D)

B. III, I, II and IV (III. The principal; I. And the Department head; II. Are presenting the school; IV. In the stakeholder's meeting)

D. IV, III, I and II (IV. In the stakeholder's meeting; III. The principal; I. And the Department head; II. Are presenting the school)

(D) is the best answer because it emphasizes the role of an introductory phrase which is to explain the background (that they are in a stakeholder's meeting) of the following statement.

51. The President is a ghost writer.

A. a valet

B. one who writes a biography

C. one who writes a speech for another

RATIONALE: (C)

Ghost writers are “writers for hire who take money but none of the credit for the work produced.” The closest answer is (C) one who writes a speech for another.

(A) A valet – a man’s personal male attendant

(B) One who writes a biography – a detailed description of a person’s life (although this suggests a writer’s work, it still cannot be considered because it is not stated in this phrase whether or not the biography is written for another person)

52. Don't fool me. I was not born yesterday.

A. not stupid

B. can't be outwitted

C. not ignorant

RATIONALE: (A. Not stupid)

Another way of telling someone that you are not “stupid” and not easily “deceived,” is by saying, “I was not born yesterday.” The closest answer is letter (A) not stupid

B. can't be outwitted – less likely the answer because by saying this, you are saying that you can't be defeated by someone because you are more clever. (but with I was not born yesterday – your goal is not to say that you are more clever but just to inform someone that you are fully aware of something).

C. not ignorant – second best option but stupid is still the more appropriate word.

**53. He is old enough to know the
TRICKS OF THE TRADE.**

A. the status of the trade

**B. technique of handling the
business.**

C. the problems of the business.

RATIONALE: (B)

“Tricks of the trade” means “clever or ingenious skills, techniques, or methods used by professionals to do something more easily or efficiently.”

In the sentence, tricks of the trade is not merely knowing (A) the status of the trade and (B) problems of the business but knowing how to (techniques) handle the business per se.

54. The thief was caught red-handed with the iPad.

A. caught in the act

B. caught about to steal the iPad

C. caught and arrested

RATIONALE: (A. caught in the act)

“Caught red-handed” means “to discover someone while they are doing something bad or illegal.” The correct answer is (A).

(B) caught about to steal the iPad – is wrong because they were caught before the act.

(C) caught and arrested – is wrong because the definition doesn't include being arrested.

**55. If given a chance, I'll
join the business for keeps.**

A. for maintenance

B. permanently

C. temporarily

RATIONALE: (B. permanently)

“For keeps” is an informal word which means “permanently; indefinitely.” The correct answer is (B).

(C) temporarily, on the other hand, is the antonym of permanently.

56. The President can see the mountain but he can't see the forest.

A. he understands the problem but he can't see the details.

B. he can see some details but can't see the whole problem.

C. he can see the problem but he has no fund for it.

RATIONALE: (B)

The phrase “can see the mountain but can’t see the forest” sprang from the main saying:

“Can’t see the forest for the trees.” (The word trees was replaced with mountain). The said saying means that someone cannot see, understand, or focus on a situation in its entirety (whole) due to being preoccupied with minor details. Hence, the closest answer is (B) he can see some details but can’t see the whole problem.

**57. He is intelligent, but he bites
more than he can chew.**

A. he is a talkative braggart.

B. he talks more than he can do.

**C. He speaks well beyond one's
expectation.**

RATIONALE: (B)

If you “bite off more than you can chew,” it means that you are trying to do something that is too difficult for you, something that is **MORE** than what you are capable of doing. The closest answer is (B) he talks more than he can do. He talks and talks but he cannot carry out or accomplish such.

(A) he is a talkative braggart – a braggart is a person who boasts about his achievements (does not say anything about doing something that is difficult for one’s self)

(C) He speaks well beyond one’s expectation – if one speaks well beyond expectation, it means that even if it is difficult, he can do it.

58. A couple enjoyed a wedding ceremony they attended when they said:

- A. The ceremonies were impressive.**
- B. All guests congratulated the couple.**
- C. I do not agree with that priest said.**
- D. Guests were talking about the ceremonies.**

RATIONALE: (A)

A. The ceremonies were impressive – the sentence is directly (ceremonies) and explicitly (impressive) saying that, indeed, the ceremonies are “deserving attention, admiration, respect” – which is the meaning of impressive.

B. All guests congratulated the couple – there was no reaction given to the “ceremonies” per se but the couple themselves.

C. I do not agree with that priest said - there was no reaction given to the “ceremonies” per se but the priest; in addition, the word “I do not” suggest that it was not enjoyable.

D. Guests were talking about the ceremonies – there may be a mention of ceremonies here but it was not stated if the talk about the ceremonies included a positive regard.

59. Archimedes, after discovering the principles of density, shouted Eureka!" Since then the word has been used to mean a:

- A. Solution**
- B. Surprise**
- C. Discovery**
- D. Mystery**

RATIONALE: (C. Discovery)

The word Eureka is an interjection which means “I have found (it). It is the reputed exclamation of Archimedes when, after a long study, he discovered a method of detecting the amount of alloy mixed with the gold in the crown of the king of Syracuse.

Based on the fact above, the closest meaning is (C) discovery.

**60. The new lock was set up
for your:**

A. Reward

B. Award

C. Absence

D. Mystery

RATIONALE: (C. Absence)

Why is a lock needed for daily living?

It is not really for a/an:

(A) Reward

(B) Award

It also is not for

(C) Mystery

But for protection: so that when the owner is not around or is absent, robbers won't be able to enter his residence or anything alike.

61. What you said does not hold water with me. What does the statement mean?

- A. Believable**
- B. Unbelievable**
- C. Understandable**
- D. Unimportant**

RATIONALE: (B. Unbelievable)

HOLD WATER: If an argument does not hold water, it does not seem to be reasonable or be in accordance with the facts; in short, it is not true. The closest answer is (B) Unbelievable – difficult or impossible to believe. Normally, people don't believe things that are not true.

(A)Believable – antonym of unbelievable

(C)Understandable – can be comprehended (another meaning of it is “to accept as a fact or truth – deviating from the meaning of does not hold water

(D) Unimportant – lacking in importance (but not lacking in TRUTH)

62. How can the following be interpreted? “I am used to the same tales”

A. It is very original

B. It is news

C. There was a miscommunication

D. There is nothing new in the story

RATIONALE: (D)

When someone is “used to” already in doing something, it means has become familiar to him or her over the course of time. And when something is familiar, it is not new or strange to him anymore. Hence, the closest answer is (D) There is nothing new in the story.

(A) It is very original – would get a different reaction from others, perhaps admiration, but not familiarity

(B) It is news – news are usually new and updated

(C) There was a miscommunication – deviates from the meaning of the sentence

63. The principal claims she was kept in the dark in the situation the school is facing. What does the statement mean?

- A. He understood the situation.**
- B. She doesn't know the situation.**
- C. She failed to understand the situation.**
- D. She cannot understand the situation.**

RATIONALE: (B.)

KEEP IN THE DARK: uninformed; a state of ignorance.

When someone is uninformed, it only means that (B) she doesn't know the situation, because she was not informed.

64. What is the theme of the following quote? Nothing that happens in this world ever happens by chance; it is all part of a grand design.

A. Luck

B. Destiny

C. Ambition

D. Dream

RATIONALE: (B. Destiny)

- (A) Luck – the things that happen to a person because of chance**
- (B) Destiny – a power that is believed to control what happens in the future**
- (C) Ambition – a particular goal or aim**
- (D) Dream – something that you have wanted very much to do, be, or have**

In the sample passage, there is no hint about ambition or dream. On the other hand, luck is related to chance but in the passage “nothing happens by chance.” So we are left with the best answer which is (B) destiny – where the future is controlled. The line that supports that is “it is all part of a grand design.”

65. In the Road Not Taken by Robert Frost use the line “and my little horse must think it queer...” which of the following figures of speech is used by the poet?

- A. Metaphor**
- B. Simile**
- C. Hyperbole**
- D. Personification**

RATIONALE: (D. Personification)

Personification – figure of speech in which a thing – an idea or an animal – is given human attributes.

The ability of the horse to “think” qualifies as a personification because the poet gave a human characteristic or ability to a nonhuman (horse).

(A) Metaphor – an expression that describes a person or object by referring to something that is considered to possess similar characteristics (no “as” or “like” – you are the sun)

(B) Simile – figure of speech comparing two unlike things that is often introduced by like or as (e.g. cheeks like roses)

(C) Hyperbole – an expression which uses exaggeration for the sake of emphasis (I have a million things to do)

66. Which of the following has no structural error/s?

A. She and I are classmates. OURSELVES are friends.

B. Mary and Angie are talking on the Phone. THEY are friends.

C. Jenny and Tessie are cousins. THEMSELVES are very close.

D. The 3 girls knew each other from high school. THEIRSELVES are acquaintances.

RATIONALE: (B.)

SUBJECT PRONOUNS (subjects of a verb/sentence) Ex. HE is my friend.	REFLEXIVE PRONOUNS (refer to the subject forms of personal pronouns) Ex. We didn't decorate it OURSELVES.
I	Myself
He	Himself
She	Herself
It	Itself
You (singular)	Yourself
You (plural)	Yourselves
They	Themselves
One	Oneself
We	Ourselves

RATIONALE: (B.)

(A) And (C) are reflexive nouns – they are not parallel with what is asked of the sentence which is a subject pronoun. The only subject pronoun is (B) They.

On the other hand, there is no word such as (D) Themselves.

67. Which of those capitalized words does not belong to the group in terms of sound?

A. BLESS me and my family

B. The MESS is extraordinary

C. To EXPRESS on the issue is a wise action

D. She CARRIES her baby on her shoulder

RATIONALE: (D.)

(A) BLESS

(B) MESS

(C) EXPRESS

The following options all have short e vowel sounds.

While (D) CARRIES – has a long e vowel sound.

68. She isn't joining the game:

A. Is she

B. Isn't she

C. Does she

D. Aren't she

RATIONALE: (A. Is she)

The given sentence is an example of a Question Tag.

RULES ON QUESTION TAG:

> Positive/Negative:

If the main part of the sentence is positive, the question tag is negative. And if the main part of the sentence is negative, the question tag is positive.

Example:

> He is a doctor, isn't he? (is – positive/ isn't – negative)

> He isn't a doctor, is he? (isn't – negative/ is – positive)

69. Foreign factories have begun to automate their manufacturing by using robots. What does the word automate mean?

A. Create cheap products

B. Operate through machines

C. Operate through human products

D. Create automatic products

RATIONALE: (B.)

“Automate,” according to Merriam Webster’s dictionary, is to “run or operate (something, such as a factory or system) by using machines, computers, etc. instead of people to do the work. The closest answer is (B) Operate through machines.

70. Margo's comments are generally not nebulous, but clear. What does nebulous mean?

- A. Apparent**
- B. Precise**
- C. Ambiguous**
- D. Accurate**

RATIONALE: (C. Ambiguous)

(A) Apparent - easy to see or understand

(B) Precise – very accurate and exact

(D) Accurate – free from mistakes or errors

Nebulous – not clear; difficult to see, understand and describe.

The word nebulous is synonymous with ambiguous. Hence, (C) is the correct answer.

71. “Oh Rizal, is this the youth you said would be the hope of the motherland?” This is an example of a :

- A. Allusion**
- B. Metaphor**
- C. Synecdoche**
- D. Apostrophe**

RATIONALE: (D. Apostrophe)

(D) Apostrophe – the addressing of a usually absent person or a usually personified thing rhetorically

In the given sentence, “Rizal” – an absent as well as a dead person is being addressed rhetorically.

(A) Allusion – an implied or indirect reference

(B) Metaphor - an expression that describes a person or object by referring to something that is considered to possess similar characteristics (no “as” or “like” – you are the sun)

(C) Synecdoche – a figure of speech by which a part is put for the whole (e.g. fifty sail for fifty ships)

72. What does the line for Confucius mean: “On the day, find the right way, die properly at night?”

A. We need to live from morning until night time.

B. We have to divide our time from morning until night time.

C. We need to work hard in the morning so we can die at night.

D. We need to work hard in the morning so we can die at night.

RATIONALE: (B.)

(C) and (D) – are just the same and not the best answers because the statement was taken literally.

We are left with two best options: (A) and (B).

(A) We need to live from morning until night time.

(B) We have to divide our time from morning until night time.

The best answer is (B) because in order to find the “right” way is to divide (fairly/rightly) our time. If we divide our time that way, we can die at night or sleep soundly because we know that we have done what should be done.

73. _____ you need the papers, call Giuliani and she'll assist you.

A. On Case

B. In Case

C. Just Case

D. By the use

RATIONALE: (B. In Case)

**“In case” here is used as conjunction which means “if.”
All other options are wrong.**

74. Before the competition, the coach told his team to bring home the bacon.

A. The team has to go to the market.

B. The team has to win in the competition.

C. The team has to compete with enthusiasm.

D. The team has to cheat in the competition.

RATIONALE: (B)

BRING HOME THE BACON: achieve success.

(A), (C), and (D) do not suggest “success.” Only (B) does. By winning the competition, they would achieve success.

**75. There should be a
CESSATION of inequity in the
world.**

A. Continuity

B. Stop

C. Movement

D. Patronage

RATIONALE: (B. Stop)

“Cessation” means “a stopping of some action.” The closest answer is (B) Stop.

(A) Continuity – the quality of something that does not stop or change as time passes

(C) Movement – the act of moving from one place to another

(D) Patronage –support that is given to a business, library, etc., by buying its goods or using its services

76. The Philippines is considered as a/an _____ nation.

A. ESL

B. EFL

C. English Speaking

D. Foreign sounding

RATIONALE: (C. English Speaking)

A. ESL – English as a Second Language

B. EFL – English as a Foreign Language

(A) And (B) when followed by nation wouldn't make any sense. So we are left with two best options which are (C) and (D)

C. English Speaking (best answer because English is the language that is imbedded in the curriculum of the Philippines)

D. Foreign sounding (not the answer because Filipinos have their own accent far from foreigners)

77. Which phrase is associated WITH President Ramon Magsaysay?

A. For democracy will die.

B. For whom the bells tolls.

C. To all the girls I have loved before.

D. To whom it may concern.

RATIONALE: (A.)

**“Everywhere that you would look/was a bandit or a crook
Peace and order was a joke/til Magsaysay pumasok/
That is why, that is why/you will hear the people cry/
Our democracy will die kung wala si Magsaysay.”**

“During the 1950’s, Ramon Magsaysay was about to run for president. The jingle was crafted around Magsaysay’s image as a fighter against communist guerrillas. It was one the United States adored. But in the context of America’s concern with communism infiltrating Southeast Asia, a different shade surfaces. (Our democracy will die kung wala si Magsaysay) is a faint reminder that Magsaysay – and only – could save this nation from the communists. (Gentle persuasion or subtle mind control is the listener’s prerogative).”

78. The Vice-President for Academics gave her secretary an urgent instruction. Which of the following would be the most appropriate response from the secretary?

A. I'll act on that immediately Ma'am! You'll have it on your desk as soon as possible.

B. How urgent is that Ma'am! You'll have it on your desk as soon as possible.

C. I'll take care of that after I'm done with my current task Ma'am.

RATIONALE: (A.)

B. How urgent is that Ma'am! You'll have it on your desk as soon as possible.

C. I'll take care of that after I'm done with my current task Ma'am.

Since the secretary is not sure when she can pass the task plus she knows that it is urgent, the best answer is (A) I'll act on that immediately Ma'am! You'll have it on your desk as soon as possible. Of course she cannot say explicitly to the VPA that it is (B) urgent because she might offend her. And she cannot hint to the VPA that what she's doing at the moment is more important than the task given to her like what she could say in letter (C).

79. Which sentence is clearly expressed and has no error?

A. The farmer plowed, has planted and has harvested is corn in record time.

B. The farmer has plowed, planted and harvested his corn in record time.

C. The farmer plowed, planted and harvested his corn in record time.

D. The farmer did plow plant, harvest his corn in record time.

RATIONALE: (C.)

**Only (C) adheres to the rule of parallelism.
“Plowed,” “planted,” and “harvested” are
all verbs in the past tense.**

**(A) Plowed + has planted + has harvested
= not parallel**

**(B) Has plowed + planted + harvested = not
parallel**

(D) Did plow plant + harvest = not parallel

80. Which of the following questions belong to the Literal comprehension level?

A. In the story, who is slow?

B. Why is it good to be persistent?

C. What are the advantages and disadvantages of being quick?

D. Do you agree with the tortoise when it said that it best to be what you are?

RATIONALE: (A.)

LEVELS OF READING COMPREHENSION

I. Literal – what is actually stated (in the passage)

>Common questions used to illicit this type of thinking are who, what, when, and where questions.

II. Interpretive – what is implied or meant, rather than what is actually stated.

>Types of questions are open-ended, thought provoking questions like why, what if, and how.

III. Applied – taking what was said (literal) and what was meant (interpretive) and then extend (apply) the concepts or ideas beyond the situation.

(A) Requires only the literal level of reading comprehension because it is a question which answer could be gotten from what is stated in a certain passage. While (C), although it starts with “what” requires more than just a literal level of comprehension as elaboration should be given.

81. Who died at the end of Iliad?

A. Hector

B. Achilles

C. Agamemnon

D. Menelaus

RATIONALE: (A. Hector)

“And so the Trojans buried Hector breaker of horses” (24:944).

Iliad ends with Hector finally being put to rest after his death from Achilles’ doing: spearing of the throat.

82. Which is Rousseau's one of the important works on political philosophy?

A. The Social Contract

B. Discourse on method

C. The treatises of Government

D. Candied

RATIONALE: (A. The Social Contract)

(A) The Social Contract by Rousseau is a book in which Rousseau theorized about the best way to establish a political community in the face of problems of commercial society.

(B) Discourse on method – Rene Descartes

(C) The treatises of Government – John Locke

83. What is the smallest unit of sound of any language teaching in the Philippines?

- A. Morpheme**
- B. Allophone**
- C. Phoneme**
- D. Allomorph**

RATIONALE: (C. Phoneme)

(A) Morpheme – a word or a part of a word that has meaning and that contains no smaller part that has meaning.

(B) Allophone – any of the speech sounds that represent a single phoneme, such as the aspirated k in kit and the unaspirated k in skit, which are allophones of the phoneme k.

(C) Phoneme – is the smallest unit of language that may cause a change of meaning within a language but that doesn't have meaning by itself.

(D) Allomorph – any of the versions of a morpheme, such as the plural endings s (as in bats) z, (as in bugs), and iz (as in buses), for the plural morpheme.

84. The goals of English language teaching in the Philippines is to produce learners who:

A. Can communicate accurately, fluently and appropriately

B. Have mastery of English pronunciation and grammar

C. Can use English in proper context

D. Can confidently speak in English

RATIONALE: (A.)

The end goals teaching and learning are communicative competence and multi-literacies.

> Communicative competence is the student's ability to understand and use the language appropriately and correctly to communicate in authentic situations.

The second goal of English language teaching is multi-literacies. The term comes from “multi” and “literacy” and implies that text is not the only way to communicate. Text is combined with sound and images. It is incorporated into movies, billboards, almost the site of the internet and television.

RATIONALE: (A.)

Aside from that, the Learning Area Standard specifies the intended outcomes of the English subject from K to 12. For English, the Learning Area Standard is:

“The learner demonstrates mastery of the basic skills in the English Language Arts, communicates appropriately, fluently, and orally and writes for a variety of purposes in different social and academic context at his/her level while carrying out real life tasks necessary to cope with the demands of a functionally literate and competent, local, national, and global citizen.”s

85. Which of the following is the story of a scholar who sold his soul to the devil in exchange for knowledge?

A. Faust

B. Lucinde

C. Candide

D. Sorrows of the Young Werther

RATIONALE: (A. Faust)

Faust is the protagonist of a classic German legend, based on the historical Johann Georg Faust. Faust is an erudite who is highly successful yet dissatisfied with his life, which leads him to make a pact with the Devil, exchanging his soul for unlimited knowledge and worldly pleasures. “Faust” and the adjective “Faustian” imply a situation in which an ambitious person surrenders moral integrity in order to achieve power and success for a delimited term.

86. What is the usual ending of a Comedia?

- A. Victory of Muslim**
- B. Death of the Queen**
- C. Victory of Christians**
- D. Death of the Prince**

RATIONALE: (C. Victory of Christians)

In a Comedia, the conversion always takes place before the marriage, which punctuates the ending of the performance and firmly ratifies status quo. In this way, the foreign lover, male or female, has performed a transformative act that linked the travel through the Mediterranean Sea to conversion. Cartography has opened the door to spiritual conversion. Thus, while the frame remains comic, for the young lovers who symbolized the future, the identification with Christianity has been maintained in the performances.

87. What is the English translation of Rabindranath Tagore's "Gitanjali."

- A. Patriotic Hymns**
- B. Song of songs**
- C. Songs Offerings**
- D. Devotional Song**

RATIONALE: (C. Songs Offerings)

The English Gitanjali or Song Offerings is a collection of 103 poems of Tagore's own English translations of his Bengali poems first published in November 1912 by the India Society of London.

88. Which of the following best describes the Readers Theatre?

A. Readers do a lot of action

B. Long hours are spent rehearsing

C. Students do not memorize their parts

D. The theatres requires elaborate props and costumes

RATIONALE: (C)

Reader's Theatre is a school activity in which a presenter reads in front of an audience. Similar to theatre, the presenter reads the scripts with expressions, emotions, and voice-modulation. But, in contrast with a theatre, the presenter doesn't learn his or her lines. The presenter performs the play by using non-verbal communication i.e. voice, facial expressions, and gestures. In a reader's theatre, there is no need for sets, costumes, or other props.

(A) – yes but more salient with theatre plays

(B) - yes but just like with any performance

(D)- no

89. Gnomonic verses are the earliest form of literacy expression during the pre-colonial period in Philippine literature. Which is NOT an example of gnomonic verse?

- A. Fable**
- B. Legend**
- C. Riddle**
- D. Folktale**

RATIONALE: (A. Fable)

The word gnomonic, comes from gnome, meaning “dwarf.” The gnomonic verses, therefore, are poetic lines which are short and compressed. Examples of which in Philippines literature are riddles (bugtong), epigrams/maxims/proverbs, bulong (chants), sayings (kasabihan), tanaga, myths (oral literature), metrical tales, folk songs.

(C) Riddles are obvious examples of gnomonic verses,
(B) Legends as well as (Folktale) are closely related to myths, which is an example of a gnomonic verse.
Therefore, the answer is (A) Fable.

90. Which language system is focused on vocabulary?

A. Semantics

B. Syntactic

C. Pragmatic

D. Phonological

RATIONALE: (A. Semantics)

(A) Semantics – the study of the meanings of words and phrases in language; refers to the meaning of the vocabulary symbols.

(B) Syntactic – concerned with the way in which linguistic elements (such as words) are put together to form constituents (such as phrases and clauses); grammatical structures.

(C) Pragmatic – studies the ways in which context contributes to meaning (e.g. speech act theory, conversational implicature)

(D) Phonological – study of sound patterns and their meanings, both within and across languages.

In short: (A) – VOCABULARY; (B) – GRAMMAR; (C) – CONTEXT; (D) - SOUND

91. The following are Elizabethan playwrights. Who does NOT belong to the group?

A. Johnson

B. Dante

C. Shakespeare

D. Marlowe

RATIONALE: (B. Dante)

Elizabethan Plays and Playwrights were extremely popular during the Elizabethan era, and many of their plays are still performed today. The most famous of the Elizabethan playwrights was (C) William Shakespeare. Other famous ones were:

- (A) Ben Johnson (Volpon, The Silent Woman, The Alchemist)
- (D) Christopher Marlowe (Dr. Faustus)

Only (D) Dante Alghieri was not included. He belongs to the Late Middle Ages.

92. Which play of Jose M. Hernandez tells of an artisan who forged cannons for use of the Spaniards?

- A. The Panday Pira**
- B. The Real Leader**
- C. The Filipino Rebel**
- D. The Cry of the Philippines**

RATIONALE: (A. The Panday Pira)

“Panday Pira” is a play written by Jose Ma. Hernandez. It is a story of a Pampango Indio blacksmith who is acknowledged as the “First Filipino Cannon-maker” and about how he managed to work as a blacksmith during the time of Rajah Sulayman and Governor General Miguel Lopez de Legazpi.

93. What figure of speech is used in the sentence below?

“I cried a million times for you.”

A. Hyperbole

B. Simile

C. Personification

D. Metaphor

RATIONALE: (A. Hyperbole)

Hyperbole – an expression which uses exaggeration for the sake of emphasis (I have a million things to do)

In the sentence, to show the heartache of the person, the persona used exaggerated words to prove his/her point. No one can cry a million times for someone in its literal sense.

(B) Simile – figure of speech comparing two unlike things that is often introduced by like or as (e.g. cheeks like roses)

(C) Personification - figure of speech in which a thing – an idea or an animal – is given human attributes. (e.g. cats cry)

(D) Metaphor – an expression that describes a person or object by referring to something that is considered to possess similar characteristics (no “as” or “like” – you are the sun)

94. Identify the poem from which the quoth “nevermore” is taken:

A. Ulaluma- A balad

B. Lenore

C. The Sleeper

D. The Raven

RATIONALE: (D. The raven)

In Edgar Allan Poe's 18-stanza poem, "The Raven," the line "Quoth the Raven, Nevermore," comes in toward the middle and gets repeated or the word "nevermore" gets repeated, in the subsequent stanzas. Here are some lines from the poem:

Then this ebony bird beguiling my sad fancy into
smiling / By the grave and stern decorum
countenance it wore / Through my crest be shorn and
shaven, thou / I said, "art sure no craven, / Ghastly
grim and ancient Raven wandering from the Nightly
shore / Tell me what thy lordly name is on the Night's
Plutonian Shore / Quoth the Raven "Nevermore."

95. In the curing system, this is about vocabulary and coming up with meanings in a _____.

A. Syntax

B. Simile

C. Semantics

D. Morphology

RATIONALE: (C. Semantics)

A. Syntax - concerned with the way in which linguistic elements (such as words) are put together to form constituents (such as phrases and clauses); grammatical structures.

B. Simile - Simile "a figure of speech comparing two unlike things that is often introduced by like or as."

C. Semantics - the study of the meanings of words and phrases in language; refers to the meaning of the vocabulary symbols.

D. Morphology - The study and description of how words are formed in a language (e.g. inflection, derivation, compounding)

96. This period is considered as the Golden Age of the Filipino Language.

- A. American regime**
- B. Spanish Regime**
- C. Marcos Regime**
- D. Japanese Regime**

RATIONALE: (D. Japanese Regime)

Between 1941 – 1945, Philippine Literature was interrupted in its development when we were again conquered by another foreign country – Japan. Philippine literature in English then, came to a halt. Tagalog was favored by the Japanese military authority and writing in English was consigned to a limbo. Japanese were able to influence and encourage the Filipino in developing the vernacular literature. Thus, Filipino literature was given a break during this period.

97. The problem that I encountered was _____ for me to handle.

- A. too much**
- B. so much**
- C. very much**
- D. too more**

RATIONALE: (A. Too much)

The words too, so, and very are degree modifiers. Generally speaking, so and very have positive meanings. Too, on the other hand, shows negative extremes, just like in the example sentence. The problem was (to a higher degree than desired) “too” or extremely negative to be handled.

**(D) Too more – is incorrect
(superlative/comparative)**

98. If Divine comedy is characterized by absolute faith in a single truth, which of the following is the characteristic of Boccaccio's Decameron?

- A. Characteristics of merchant class**
- B. An equally devout reference for this truth**
- C. A complete negation of Christian doctrine**
- D. A sexual libertinism that seeks to receive the great pleasure of Ancient Rome**

RATIONALE: (C.)

In Boccasio's Decameron, religion is a favorite topic of mockery. Most of the religious characters are Abbots, Nuns, Priests, Friars or Monks who trick the men and the women of the Novellas into following their schemes, be it sex or money or other goals. The Decameron definitely takes a humorous and critical approach to describing the clergy in action. Clergy members are only human, and often possess little morality and zealous carnal desires. Besides Christianity, there is mention of Judaism and the Muslim faith, and corresponding characters.

**99. Not all ED's in verbs sound alike.
Which ED is different?**

- A. She signed a contract**
- B. She wanted a chaperon**
- C. She was not granted in audience**
- D. She failed to get the needed
answer**

***BONUS**

RATIONALE: (BONUS)

PRONUNCIATION OF “ED”

/id/	/t/	/d/
T – wanted	P – helped	L – called
D – needed	K – looked	N – cleaned
	F – sniffed	R – offered
	GH – laughed	G – damaged
	SH – washed	V – loved
	CH – watched	S – used
	SS – kissed	Z – amazed
	C – danced	B – rubbed
	X – fixed	M – claimed

RATIONALE: (BONUS)

/id/ - (B) and (C)

/d/ - (A) and (D)

But for the sake of answering this since there should be no item left unanswered, one could just choose (A), and the basis is the sequence of the last letters in the alphabet.

100. Which sentence uses a preposition improperly?

A. The witness was barely IN time for the affair,

B. The accident happened ON his birthday.

C. She came ON attend the hearing.

D. Tell her to be ON time.

RATIONALE: (C.)

All of the following exhibit the proper use of prepositions except for (C) She came ON attend the hearing. “ON” should be “TO.”

101. Which of the following sentences is syntactically correct?

- A. What you stated was a true fact.**
- B. What you stated was a true fact.**
- C. You stated a true fact.**

RATIONALE: (C. You stated a true fact.)

When it comes to grammar and correct usage, the sentence that is best is the one that is concise: short but clear. (A) and (B) are the same, plus, it is the shortest and clearest version of (C).

102. Which of the following sentences is syntactically correct?

A. The ball is round in shape.

B. In shape, the ball is round.

C. The ball is round.

RATIONALE: (C. The ball is round)

Round – shaped like a circle or ball

(A) and (B) would be redundant because of the word “shape” and the word “round” combined in both sentences.

103. Which of the following sentences is syntactically correct?

A. Please, repeat it again.

B. Please, repeat it.

C. Please, repeat by doing it again.

RATIONALE: (B. Please, repeat it)

Repeat – to say (something) again

(A) And (C) would be redundant because of the word “again” and the word “repeat” combined in both sentences.

104. Which of the following sentences is syntactically correct?

A. Attending parties and fishing in the river made our vacation thrilling.

B. Attending parties and to fish in the river made our vacation thrilling.

C. To attend parties and fishing in the river made our vacation thrilling.

RATIONALE: (A)

Only (A) adheres to the rule of parallelism. Attending and fishing both end in -ing.

(B) Attending + To fish = not parallel

(C) To attend + Fishing = not parallel

105. Which of the following sentences is syntactically correct?

A. It is hard to study and working at the same time.

B. It is hard to study, working at the same time.

C. It is hard to study and to work at the same time.

RATIONALE: (C)

Only (C) adheres to the rule of parallelism. To + study plus to + work. Both verbs have “to” before them.

(A) To study + working = not parallel

(B) To study + working = not parallel

106. Which of the following sentences is syntactically correct?

A. She enjoys going to parties and talking with friends.

B. She enjoys going to parties and to walk with friends.

C. She enjoys going to parties and to walk with friends.

RATIONALE: (A)

Only (A) adheres to the rule of parallelism. Going and talking both end in -ing.

(B) Going + to walk = not parallel

(C) Going + to walk = not parallel

107. Which of the following sentences is syntactically correct?

A. I like dancing, swimming and to read.

B. I like dancing, swimming and reading.

C. I like to dance, swimming and reading.

RATIONALE: (B)

Only (B) adheres to the rule of parallelism. Dancing, swimming, and reading all end in -ing.

(A) Dancing + swimming + to read = not parallel

(C) Dance + swimming + reading = not parallel

108. “I saved the crown.”

A. metonymy

B. metaphor

C. simile

D. allusion

RATIONALE: (A. Metonymy)

(B) Metaphor – an expression that describes a person or object by referring to something that is considered to possess similar characteristics (no “as” or “like” – you are the sun)

(C) Simile – figure of speech comparing two unlike things that is often introduced by like or as (e.g. cheeks like roses)

(D) Allusion – an implied or indirect reference

Metonymy – is a figure of speech that replaces the name of a thing with the name of something else with which it is closely associated.

In the example sentence, triumph is replaced by the word crown.

109. “I crossed seven rivers and mountains just to see you.”

A. antitheses

B. paradox

C. hyperbole

D. synecdoche

RATIONALE: (C. Hyperbole)

(A) Antitheses – is the use of contrasting concepts, words, or sentences within parallel grammatical structures. (e.g. float like a butterfly, sting like a bee)

(B) Paradox – is a statement that may seem absurd or contradictory but yet can be true or at least makes sense (e.g. freedom is slavery)

(D) Synecdoche – a figure of speech by which a part is put for the whole (e.g. fifty sail for fifty ships)

Hyperbole – an expression which uses exaggeration for the sake of emphasis (I have a million things to do)

In the sentence, to show the effort of the person, he used exaggerated words to prove his point. No one can cross seven rivers in its literal sense.

110. “The hungry flames ate all the shanties in the area.”

A. irony

B. allusion

C. metonymy

D. personification

RATIONALE: (D. Personification)

(A) Irony – an expression by using language that normally signifies the opposite, typically for humorous or emphatic effect (What a nice day! – when you had the worst day)

(B) Allusion – an implied or indirect reference

(C) Metonymy – is a figure of speech that replaces the name of a thing with the name of something else with which it is closely associated. (e.g. crown for monarchy)

Personification – figure of speech in which a thing – an idea or an animal – is given human attributes.

The ability of the flames to “eat” qualifies as a personification because the former, a non-living thing has a living characteristic.

111. “Jose is a walking calculator.”

A. simile

B. metaphor

C. litotes

D. oxymoron

RATIONALE: (B. Metaphor)

(A) Simile – figure of speech comparing two unlike things that is often introduced by like or as (e.g. cheeks like roses)

(C) Litotes – is a figure of speech in which a negative statement is used to affirm a positive statement. (e.g. Lea Salonga is not a bad singer.)

(D) Oxymoron – is a figure of speech in which apparently contradictory terms appear in conjunction (e.g. cruel kindness; to make haste slowly)

Metaphor – an expression that describes a person or object by referring to something that is considered to possess similar characteristics (no “as” or “like” – you are the sun)

In the sentence, Jose is likened to a walking calculator.

112. “She walks like a duck.”

A. simile

B. irony

C. metaphor

D. litotes

RATIONALE: (A. Simile)

(B) Irony - an expression by using language that normally signifies the opposite, typically for humorous or emphatic effect (What a nice day! – when you had the worst day)

(C) Metaphor – an expression that describes a person or object by referring to something that is considered to possess similar characteristics (no “as” or “like” – you are the sun)

(D) Litotes – is a figure of speech in which a negative statement is used to affirm a positive statement. (e.g. Lea Salonga is not a bad singer.)

Simile - figure of speech comparing two unlike things that is often introduced by like or as (e.g. cheeks like roses)

In the sentence, “she” is likened to a duck with the use of the word “like.” Hence, the correct answer is A.

**113. The problem _____
difficult.**

A. appears

B. looks

C. sounds

D. seems

RATIONALE: (D. Seems)

One should use “look or appear” when describing an observable condition (e.g. Rhonda looks sad. – implies that there is some observable state or behavior that supports the statement: Rhonda may have tears rolling down her eyes, for example)

One should use “seem” to describe a perceived condition – (e.g. Rhonda seems sad – implies that the person making the statement has a perception regarding the condition of the subject)

One should use “sounds” to describe a heard/read condition – (e.g. Rhonda sounds sad – someone said Rhonda is sad or you heard her crying).

RATIONALE: (D. Seems)

In the example sentence, it is more likely that the person speaking has a perceived notion of the difficulty of the problem. Hence, the best answer is (D) seems.

**114. Your experience _____
unbelievable.**

A. seems

B. sounds

C. looks

D. appears

RATIONALE: (B. Sounds)

One should use “look or appear” when describing an observable condition (e.g. Rhonda looks sad. – implies that there is some observable state or behavior that supports the statement: Rhonda may have tears rolling down her eyes, for example)

One should use “seem” to describe a perceived condition – (e.g. Rhonda seems sad – implies that the person making the statement has a perception regarding the condition of the subject)

One should use “sounds” to describe a heard/read condition – (e.g. Rhonda sounds sad – someone said Rhonda is sad or you heard her crying).

RATIONALE: (B. Sounds)

In the example sentence, it is more likely that one heard from another his or her experience about a certain thing to reply that such experience is unbelievable (which, most of the time is a positive comment). Seems would make unbelievable have a more or less, negative connotation. While looks/appears should be stated more by the one who experienced it rather than someone who just heard it.

**115. She is one of the
candidates who _____ by
the mayor.**

A. was chosen

B. were chosen

C. are chosen

D. is chosen

RATIONALE: (A. Was chosen)

She = singular subject, requiring a singular verb

Either (A) Was chosen or (D) Is chosen seems feasible.

But the best answer is was chosen, since the act of choosing is already done.

116. Mother _____ from the States by this time next year.

A. had arrived

B. has arrived

C. shall have arrived

D. will arrive

RATIONALE: (C. Shall have arrived)

The Use of Future Perfect Tense

Future Perfect Tense – emphasizes that the action will be finished before some future time or event.

[form: will have + past participle]

(in the example sentence, will is replaced by shall)

In the sentence, by next year, (some future time/event), the mother should have arrived. (future action to be finished BEFORE the future time or event which is NEXT YEAR)

117. Although I refused to help center, she was very _____ and continued asking me.

- A. insistent**
- B. persistent**
- C. aggressive**
- D. preserving**

RATIONALE: (A. Insistent)

(A) Insistent – demanding that something happen or that someone do something

(B) Persistent – continuing to do something or to try to do something even though it is difficult

(C) Aggressive – ready and willing to fight, argue

(D) Preserving – to keep safe from harm and loss

In the sentence, the woman was clearly insistent or demanding although she was rejected already.

118. The _____ man talked badly about his friends behind their back.

- A. outspoken**
- B. domineering**
- C. conscientious**
- D. knowledgeable**

RATIONALE: (A. Outspoken)

(A) Outspoken – talking in a free and honest way about your opinions

(B) Domineering – tending too often to tell people what to do: often trying to control the behavior of others

(C) Conscientious – concerned with doing something correctly

(D) Knowledgeable – having information, understanding, or skills that comes from experience of education

Outspoken can be seen as a positive thing since it makes someone honest but being too much outspoken can also be negative as seen in the example sentence. The man already talks “badly” about his friends and even behind their back.

**119. Mrs. Jose is a/an _____
woman who does everything her
husband wants.**

A. docile

B. kind

C. eager

D. considerate

RATIONALE: (A. Docile)

(A) Docile – easily taught, led, or controlled
The word docile is synonymous with compliant which means “willing to do whatever you are asked to or ordered to do.” Hence, letter A is the answer.

(B) Kind - having or showing a gentle nature and a desire to help others

(C) Eager – very excited and interesting

(D) Considerate – showing kindness toward other people; thinking about the rights and feelings of other people.

120. The _____ man talked badly about his friends behind their back.

- A. frustrated**
- B. conceited**
- C. hypocrite**
- D. controversial**

RATIONALE: (C. Hypocrite)

- A. Frustrated – angry or annoyed because of being unable to do something**
- B. Conceited – having or showing too much pride in your own worth or goodness**
- C. Hypocrite – a person who claims or pretends to have certain beliefs about what is right but who behaves in a way that disagree with those beliefs.**
- D. Controversial – relating to or causing much discussion, disagreement, or argument (more used with celebrities or popular persons)**

The best answer is hypocrite because it is a universal rule that talking behind your friends (more even) is bad but he still does it anyway. What he disagrees to be done to him, perhaps, is also a reflection of what he does.

**121. Jenny is a _____ girl.
She believes everything you
tell her.**

- A. young**
- B. quiet**
- C. timid**
- D. gullible**

RATIONALE: (D. Gullible)

(D) Gullible – easily fooled or cheated; quick to believe something that is not true.

Since Jenny believes everything someone tells her may not that everything be true or not, she is considered as gullible.

(A) Young – not yet old

(B) Quiet – the quality or state of being quiet or calm

(C) Timid – feeling or showing a lack of courage or confidence

122. It is RUDE for a man to ask a woman her age.

A. dominant

B. impolite

C. impartial

D. indifferent

RATIONALE: (B. Impolite)

The synonym of the word “rude” is impolite.

(A) Dominant – more important, powerful, or successful

(C) Impartial – not biased

(D) Indifferent – not interested or concerned

123. The audience grew RESTIVE while the speaker was delivering his speech.

A. weary

B. exhausted

C. tired

D. restless

RATIONALE: (A. Weary)

(B) Exhausted – to use all of someone's mental or physical energy, completely (audience can't simply be exhausted through listening to a speaker)

(D) Restless – feeling nervous or bored and tending to move around a lot (audience can't really move around a lot)

It all boils down to (A) Weary and (C) Tired which have similarities in meaning. Weary, proceeds, sometimes, from an unwillingness in what we undertake; we are frequently tired, though, through disposition of body and slow circulation of blood. From experience, listening to a speaker can cause us to feel unwillingness. Hence, the best answer is A.

**124. The boy jump _____
the pool.**

A. on

B. at

C. in

D. into

RATIONALE: (D. into)

“Into” is coupled with the word jump if one suggests movement. Since it is more likely that the boy would move from outside towards the pool, the best answer is (D).

125. She arrives _____ the airport just on time.

A. on

B. at

C. in

D. by

RATIONALE: (B. at)

Use of In and At when preceded by “Arrive”

FOR PLACES:

In = general areas (countries, cities)

Example: I will arrive in Mexico.

At = specific places

Example: I will arrive at your house.

In the sentence, the airport is a specific place, hence, the answer is B.

**126. The final examinations fall
_____ last week of March.**

A. on

B. at

C. in

D. by

RATIONALE: (C. In)

General Use of In, On, and At (When it Comes to Time)

In = long periods/range of time, years, season, months

Example 1: I will do this in five years/in the last week of April.

Example 2: I did it in 2018.

Example 3: In summer, people wear loose clothing.

Example 4: I will pass my LET in September.

On = dates, days, special holiday

Example 1: I will pass the LET in September 24.

Example 2: I will pass the LET in September 24, 2018.

Example 3: I will pass it on Monday.

Example 4: We will unite on Christmas day.

At = specific time/time clock

Example 1: At 12 noon (12:00), we will eat our lunch.

Example 2: At 5:00, I will go home.

**127. My niece will leave
_____ Canada.**

A. for

B. in

C. at

D. by

RATIONALE: (A. For)

“Leave for” is used when you go away from one place and start going to another.

Example: The plane leaves for London at 10 am. (The plane leaves the airport and starts flying towards London at 10 am).

In the sentence, the niece will (leave a particular place) and head to Canada.

**128. The program begins
_____ five o'clock in the
afternoon.**

A. on

B. at

C. by

D. in

RATIONALE: (B. At)

General Use of In, On, and At (When it Comes to Time)

In = long periods/range of time, years, season, months

Example 1: I will do this in five years.

Example 2: I did it in 2018.

Example 3: In summer, people wear loose clothing.

Example 4: I will pass my LET in September.

On = dates, days, special holiday

Example 1: I will pass the LET in September 24.

Example 2: I will pass the LET in September 24, 2018.

Example 3: I will pass it on Monday.

Example 4: We will unite on Christmas day.

At = specific time/time clock

Example 1: At 12 noon (12:00), we will eat our lunch.

Example 2: At 5:00, I will go home.

**129. Mrs. Flores lives _____
a condominium unit.**

A. in

B. at

C. in

D. to

RATIONALE: (A. in)

General Use of In, On, and At:

On = “on top of,” “on the front surface of,” or “traveling for

Example 1: The cat is on the chair.

: He is on a business trip to Mexico.

In = “inside of” or “attending”

Example 1: The dirty dishes are in the dishwasher.

Example 2: Mr. Jones is in a meeting right now.

At – “near,” “visiting” or it is used for events (indoors or outdoors), or for locations where the purpose is more important than the building

Example 1: I horses were at the trough, eating.

Example 2: I saw Mary at the post office.

130. Some newspapers indulge in using scare heads.

A. threatening headlines

B. headlines written in sensational language.

C. headlines scaring business ventures.

RATIONALE: (B.)

“Scare heads” are “headlines in large type which is designed to cause a scare. It is also a slang term for a sensational newspaper headline.” The closest answer is (B) headlines written in sensational language.

131. To make it functional, an office should be given a sinking fund.

A. a fund used for emergency cases.

B. a fund used for extra-services.

C. a fund set up to meet future obligations.

RATIONALE: (C.)

“Sinking fund” refers to “assets and their earnings earmarked for a specific purpose. Business firms use sinking funds to build cash pools for future use, retiring bonds, making acquisitions, or investing. The sinking fund concepts appears in personal finance, as well, when individuals set aside for funds FOR A SPECIFIC FUTURE USE.

(A) – limited only to emergency cases

(B)- extra services are given not necessarily given in the future and for future use

132. Aside from English, we should equally master our mother tongue.

A. one's native dialect

B. one's second language

C. one's national language.

RATIONALE: (A. one's native dialect)

“Mother tongue” is a “traditional term for a person’s native language – that is, a language learned from birth. The closest answer is (A).

For example, a Cebuano child’s mother tongue is the Cebuano language. His second language could be English, and if he resides in the Philippines, his national language is Filipino.

133. It's not a sound practice for one in power to appoint political lameducks in the government.

A. politicians adept to political dynasty.

B. politicians who have political vested interest in government.

C. politicians who were previously defeated in elections.

RATIONALE: (C.)

A “lame duck” – “refers to a politician who is approaching the end of his or her term and a successor has already been chosen. A lame duck can occur when a politician has lost re-election (because he or she has dramatically less power than at the beginning of his or her term), decided to retire, abandoned office, or has exhausted his or her time limit.

The closest answer is (C) politicians who were previously defeated in elections.

(A) politicians adept to political dynasty (they actually have power)

(B) politicians who have political vested interest in government. (far from the meaning of a lameduck)

134. A good political campaign manager should know the Achilles' heel of the opposing candidate.

A. the qualifications of the opponents.

B. the smooth procedure of campaigning.

C. the vulnerable spot of one's opponent.

RATIONALE: (C.)

“Achilles’ heel” is a “weakness or a vulnerable point.” The closest answer is (C) the vulnerable spot of one’s opponent. More so, (A) and (B) are already a ‘given.’ To better win in campaigns, one should know the art of politics and among the three choices, (C) is the best to attack.

135. In the Philippines, French-leave is sometimes availed of the learned.

A. an act of leaving secretly.

B. an act of leaving with permission.

C. an act of leaving gracefully.

RATIONALE: (A)

“French leave” means “an informal, hasty, or secret departure.” Hence, the closest answer is (A) an act of leaving secretly.

(B) And (C) are acts of leaving done without secret and disgrace.

136. The evidence presented by the plaintiff is a fish history.

A. an exaggerated story.

B. a false evidence.

C. an insufficient evidence.

RATIONALE: (B.)

In the Philippines, when something is fishy, it means that something is not right or not normal. And even if you take it literally, when something is fishy, it is foul in smell. Similarly, when it comes to evidence, the best meaning of a fish history is none other than a (B) false evidence.

(A) An exaggerated story – may be exaggerated in the way it was delivered (like a sports feature) but could still be true

(C) An insufficient evidence – may lack evidence but could still be true

137. If you want to buy her a car, you have to put up an earnest money.

A. a deposit or down payment.

B. a written pledge to buy.

C. an earnest notice.

RATIONALE: (A.)

“Earnest money” is a “specific form of security deposit made in some major transactions such as real estate dealings or required by some official procurement processes to demonstrate that the applicant is serious and willing to demonstrate an earnest of good faith about wanting to complete the transaction.”

The closest answer is (A) a deposit or down payment.

(B) a written pledge to buy (although there is good faith in a written pledge, deposit or down payment is still the one needed)

(C) earnest notice (far from the meaning of earnest money)

138. Maria Clara, a CLINGING VINE, was eventually rejected by her love.

A. one who clings to one's idea.

B. one who is very dependent upon others.

C. one who prefers to plant any vine.

RATIONALE: (B.)

“Clinging vine” is a person who is submissively dependent on another. The closest answer is (B) one who is very dependent upon others.

(A) one who clings to one’s idea (suggests dependence but only to an IDEA and not a person)

(C) one who prefers to plant any vine (far from the meaning of the phrase “clinging vine”)

139. A maid with BUTTER FINGERS usually becomes the object of derision.

A. a maid who drops things easily.

B. a maid who enjoys talking butter.

C. a maid who has frail fingers.

RATIONALE: (A.)

“Butterfingers” is a “clumsy person, especially one who fails to hold a catch. One manifestation of clumsiness is when one “drops” what he or she holds countless of times. The closest answer is (A) a maid who drops things easily.

(B) – Butterfingers is an idiom so it is not meant to be taken literally.

(C) – Frail means weak or delicate (in the sentence, the one that is frail is the fingers and not how the maid holds things).

**140. The rich in this Barangay
_____ generous.**

A. is

B. was

C. are

D. were

RATIONALE: (C. are)

ADJECTIVES USED WITHOUT NOUNS

The structure “the + adjective” is used to talk about some well-known groups of people. Other examples include: the blind, the deaf, the young. Note that these expressions are always plural which also require a plural verb.

(A) Is – singular verb

(B) Was – singular verb

(C) Were – plural verb (but the statement does not suggest any time frame that happened in the past).

**141. Two-thirds of the cake
_____ eaten by Jose this
morning.**

A. is

B. was

C. are

D. were

RATIONALE: (B. was)

GENERAL RULE:

When an “of” phrase follows a percentage, distance, fraction, or amount, the verb agrees with the noun closest to the verb.

Examples:

- 1. 21% of the population is poor.**
- 2. 21% of the books are paperback.**

In the given sentence, the noun closest to the verb is cake which is singular and the time frame indicates a past happening, therefore, (B) is the answer.

142. The priest said that the blessed _____ fortunate.

A. is

B. was

C. are

D. were

RATIONALE: (C. are)

ADJECTIVES USED WITHOUT NOUNS

The structure “the + adjective” is used to talk about some well-known groups of people. Other examples include: the blind, the deaf, the young. Note that these expressions are always plural which also require a plural verb.

(A) Is – singular verb

(B) Was – singular verb

(C) Were – plural verb (but the statement does not suggest any time frame that happened in the past).

143. The number of students in that room this morning _____ twenty.

A. is

B. was

C. are

D. were

RATIONALE: (C. was)

RULES ON SUBJECT-VERB AGREEMENT

“The number of” – always singular

“A number of” – always plural

(C) Are – plural verb

(D) Were – plural verb

(A) Is – singular verb (but the event has already taken place, thus, making it less likely the answer)

**144. A number of boys _____
absent from my class for two
days now.**

A. is

B. was

C. are

D. were

RATIONALE: (D. were)

RULES ON SUBJECT-VERB AGREEMENT

“The number of” – always singular

“A number of” – always plural

(A) Is – singular verb

(B) Was – singular verb

(C) Are – plural verb (but the event has already taken place, thus, making it less likely the answer)

145. My teacher said that fifty pesos _____ not enough for lunch.

A. is

B. was

C. are

D. were

RATIONALE: (A. is)

RULES ON SUBJECT-VERB AGREEMENT

Expressions of time, money, and distance USUALLY take a singular verb.

Examples:

- 1. Ten dollars is a great deal of money.**
- 2. Ten kilometres is too far to walk.**
- 3. Six weeks is long enough.**

In the sentence, (A) is – is more likely the answer than (B) because the event hasn't already taken place yet.

**146. Nine plus six _____
fifteen.**

A. are

B. equals

C. equal

D. equal to

RATIONALE: (B. equals)

When it comes to mathematical equations, one could use “equals” or is “equal to” as both mean the same thing. Where lies the difference?

For “equal to,” remember that the former should be preceded by IS.

For “equals,” the former is NOT PRECEDED by the word is.

Hence, the correct answer is (B) Equals.

**147. Miss Clarita Santos,
together with her students,
_____ waiting for us.**

A. were

B. are

C. was

D. is

RATIONALE: (D. is)

RULE ON SUBJECT-VERB AGREEMENT

> Intervening words – sometimes a word or a phrase comes between the subject and the verb. Ignore that word/phrase when locating the subject and the verb, making sure that both agree with each other.

In the sentence, the intervening phrase is “together with her students.” While the subject, “Miss Clarita Santos” is singular. In addition, the sentence does not emphasize a past happening, that is why the best answer is (D) is.

**148. It is he who _____
guilty.**

A. is

B. was

C. are

D. were

RATIONALE: (D. is)

He – singular

Is – present tense

Given this, the verb that should be chosen should be singular as well as in its present tense to make it agree both with “he” and “is.” Hence, the answer is (D) is.

**149. Every boy and girl _____
given a gift by the Dean after
the program.**

A. is

B. was

C. are

D. were

RATIONALE: (B. was)

Rule on Subject-Verb Agreement

When two singular subjects preceded by each or every are connected with 'and,' the verb should be singular.

(A) Is – singular verb (but the time frame suggests a past happening)

(C) Are – plural verb

(D) Were – plural verb

**150. One of my students
_____ absent yesterday.**

A. is

B. was

C. are

D. were

RATIONALE: (B. was)

In the given sentence, the subject is “one” which is singular. Furthermore, the time frame “yesterday” suggests a past happening, thus, requiring not only a singular verb but also a verb in its past tense. Therefore, (B) was is the correct answer.